The Art of Teaching

By Joshua Sands

When I was seven
my Sunday school teacher first taught me the story of
Joseph
and his coat of many colors.
The story of Job is the popular story of Biblical
perseverance;
I prefer Joseph.
Ostracized by his own brothers
sent away to be a slave
Predicting great famines
yet for years,
no one knew
no one cared.
One day they realized Joseph's gifts
and there was much rejoicing.

As I regularly inhabit classroom 208
I envision myself a modern-day Joseph.

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I believe I can teach.
I await the day when my gifts will be realized.
There will be much rejoicing.

INTRODUCTION

Once I perfect The Art of Teaching by Joshua Sands.

Gradually, I lose control.
30 teachers
650 students.
Hardly fair.
They take control
like a modern-day Trojan Horse
One by one, they jump out of the horse
into 208
into 208
into 208.
The Trojans are in the classroom
assigned seats.
Plotting

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Plotting
Plotting
a takeover.
Plotting
Plotting
Plotting
My destruction.
I don't understand them
Any of them.
All of them.
I watch what they watch
read what they read
I listen.
Gradua11y, I *lose* Control.
Can I qo to the bathroom?
Tell him to stop
Is this for a qrade?
When will I need to learn this?
What time is it?
What time is it?
What time is it?
It's half past Puff Daddy.

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Do you know where your kids are?
After school:
    parent-teacher conferences.
Notice: it's always
    parent - teacher
never
teacher-parent.
Whv?
Because it's the parent approaching the teacher
the parent hearing the news
the parent finding out
what's going on
what's going on

what's going on
The parents time to catch up:
lis, he's reading at a fourth grade level.
lis, we're doing all we can.
lis, I'm sure he's doing his best.
    lis, I'll do more.
Just once
let's have

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teacher-parent conferences
where the teacher shows up at the door
and the teacher hears the news
the teacher finds out
what's going on
the teacher finds out
why this kid never gets a haircut
why this kid falls asleep in class
why this kid got caught with a *Hustler* in his locker
why this kid thinks farting is so funny
why this kid is part of the Trojan Horse.
I watch what they watch:
I see guns blazing
firing
taking over
taking over
taking over
I watch what they watch:
I see men calling each
other *BLEEP*
I see kids laughing
because they said *BLEEP*.
I watch and they're
taking over
taking over
taking over
What time is it?
What time is it?
What time is it?

It's quarter 'til Menace II Society.
Do you know where your kids are?
Eyeryone wants to know
what's going on?
what's going on?
what's going on?
You're not listening
Not listening
Not listening.
He's pulling the trigger.
Don't you get it?
He's pulling the trigger.

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He's back in the Trojan Horse now.

He's reloading.

An observer watches my class,

Gradually I lose control.

The Trojans are rioting today

It's a show.

Didn't you know?

The observer tells me:

Well, I think you need to try this

Read this

Watch this

Rework this

Be better prepared for this

for this

for this.

I've finally figured it out:

There *are* people who know what to do.

But they're all busy observing.

Gradually,

gradually,

I've lost control.

They're no longer the Trojans

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they're the *BLEEP*.

I said *BLEEP*

BLEEP

Isn't that funny?

Laugh

Isn’t it that funny?

They will sit in their seats.

They will do their work.

They will like it.

They will do it without laughing

Farting

Giggling

Passing notes

Asking to go pee

Whispering

Complaining.

They will do it or else

for 208 is my home

Don't deface my home.

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What's going on?
What's going on?
What's going on?
Stay away from 208.
I'm armed and I'm dangerous.
Stay away from 208
unless you really
read Romeo and Juliet
and are prepared to discuss it
and mean it
and like it.
Stay away from 208
because I'm gonna teach
and you don't want me to.
You can charge into 204
205
206
207
But stay away from 208.
It's my home.

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I am Joseph
waiting for the day
when I'll be told to come home.
C'mon
it was all a bad joke
You weren't meant to be a slave
You have visions
Talents
Skills
Things we need.
Come home.
Come home.
Come home.
And I wait to come home.
I wait for the meaning
the moral
the message
the reason why I went through this
Why I paid the penance.
Who would understand?
Joseph.

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Joseph would put his arms

around me and say it's OK.

It's over now.

Come home.

This is why I must join Joseph.

This is why I must go.

There must be other jobs.

I'll find one.

208 is not my home.

It never was.

What time is it?

What time is it?

What time is it?

It's time to change our tune.

Do you know where your kids are?

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Joshua Sands
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AWARD HISTORY

2007 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
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